

software, your computer is as vulnerable to it as when you didn't have a firewall. It's very important to consider what type of software you are disabling firewall protection for.

A major misconception that people have is that firewalls are effective against viruses. An antivirus software can protect your machine from viruses, the maximum a firewall can do is block worm and trojan attacks that originate over the network or via the Internet. However, a firewall that's a part of a security suite, comes bundled with an antivirus that can help your against malicious attacks.

Spam

Spam blockers have become an integral part of a secure computer. There was a time when spam could have been taken as harmless advertising, but now with the constant threat of malicious codes entering your system through spam, you need to take some serious precautions against it. But first, let's start from the top.

Spamming is the buzzword used for the use of any electronic communications medium to send unsolicited messages in bulk. The most common form of spam is delivered in e-mail inboxes as a form of commercial advertising. What differentiates spam from solicited advertising, or newsletters, is that you never signed up to receive it anywhere.

E-mail spamming involves sending identical or almost identical e-mail messages to a large number of recipients. Spam usually contains various tricks to bypass e-mail filters. Spammers obtain e-mail addresses by a number of means—some buy databases from popular Web-based sites that require you to sign up, some harvest addresses from Usenet postings, DNS listings, bulk forwards or Web pages. Some even go to the extent of guessing common names at known domains (also known as a dictionary attack).

Problems Caused By Spam

The reason spam is considered such a major issue among the masses is for a number of reasons. Firstly, we waste a lot of time and bandwidth sorting through and downloading these useless e-mails. Many popular e-mail providers will still deliver fifty to a